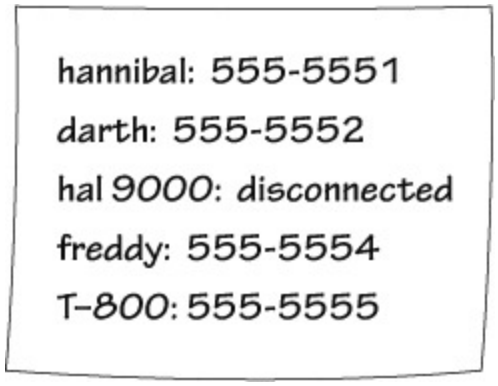
Imagine you have phone numbers of your friends written on a piece of paper (figure 4.1). You want to write a program that stores these numbers and allows you to add new numbers, change existing numbers, and check whether you have the number for a particular person. How do you express what you see on the paper in CoffeeScript?

Figure 4.1. Phone numbers



Express the list of phone numbers as an object with person names as the property names and phone numbers as the values. The object that you express as a key-value store looks similar to the paper version. Here it's assigned to a variable:

```
phoneNumbers =
  hannibal: '555-5551'
  darth: '555-5552'
  hal9000: 'disconnected'
  freddy: '555-5554'
  'T-800': '555-5555'
```

YAML-style object syntax used, no curly braces

Quoted property because T-800 isn't a valid name

Now that you have the object in your program, how do you use it?

Accessing Properties

Use dot notation on the object with the property name to get the corresponding value. For example, to call Darth, get his phone number by using the key `darth` on the object referenced by the `phoneNumbers` variable: